YOUR PARENTING PROFILE



The Bagel

F C D E

Boiled and baked, resilient, no-fuss, up for anything.

Your four letters

Your code is built from four research-backed parenting dimensions. Neither pole of any dimension is the better one.



F HOW YOU ORGANIZE THE DAY
Flow

C WHO SETS THE DIRECTION
Captain

D WHEN THE FEELINGS GET BIG
Doer

E COMFORT ZONE OR STRETCH ZONE
Explorer

For fun & reflection — not a clinical assessment or diagnostic tool.

AN EVERYDAY STORY

The Pause Before Fixing It

A bicycle wheel catches the curb and your child lands on both hands. You lift the bike, check the palms, rinse the scrape, and say, “It's okay, let's keep going.” The whole situation has a solution. Yet your child does not reach for the handlebars again.

As a Bagel parent, you have been through heat and know how to keep moving. You make hard moments smaller, manageable, and less dramatic. In a parenting world full of emotional vocabulary, that directness can make you wonder whether something is missing.



You sit on the curb before doing anything else. One breath. No fixing. “That was scary.” Your child lets out the cry they had been holding.

A minute later, they ask you to hold the bicycle while they climb back on. Practical care was never the problem; it simply arrived before the feeling had somewhere to go. You do not need a therapy speech. One honest word can connect the body, the emotion, and the next step. Even you are allowed to sit beside a problem before turning it into a task.



WHAT TO REMEMBER

WHAT OFTEN HAPPENS

You are resilient, practical, and dislike making a problem bigger than it needs to be. In a parenting culture full of new terms, you can feel insensitive simply because your style is direct.

RELEASE THE GUILT

Your child does not need a therapy speech every time. Concrete help is love; add just one sign that you see the feeling.



YOUR SUPERPOWERS

1. Unflappable in tantrum weather
2. Practical problem-solver on the fly
3. Adventure without the itinerary

WATCH-OUT, WITH LOVE

"Shake it off" can accidentally dismiss. One feeling word before the fix works wonders. 🥯

YOUR POP-CULTURE COUSIN

Rough-and-tumble / FAFO-lite



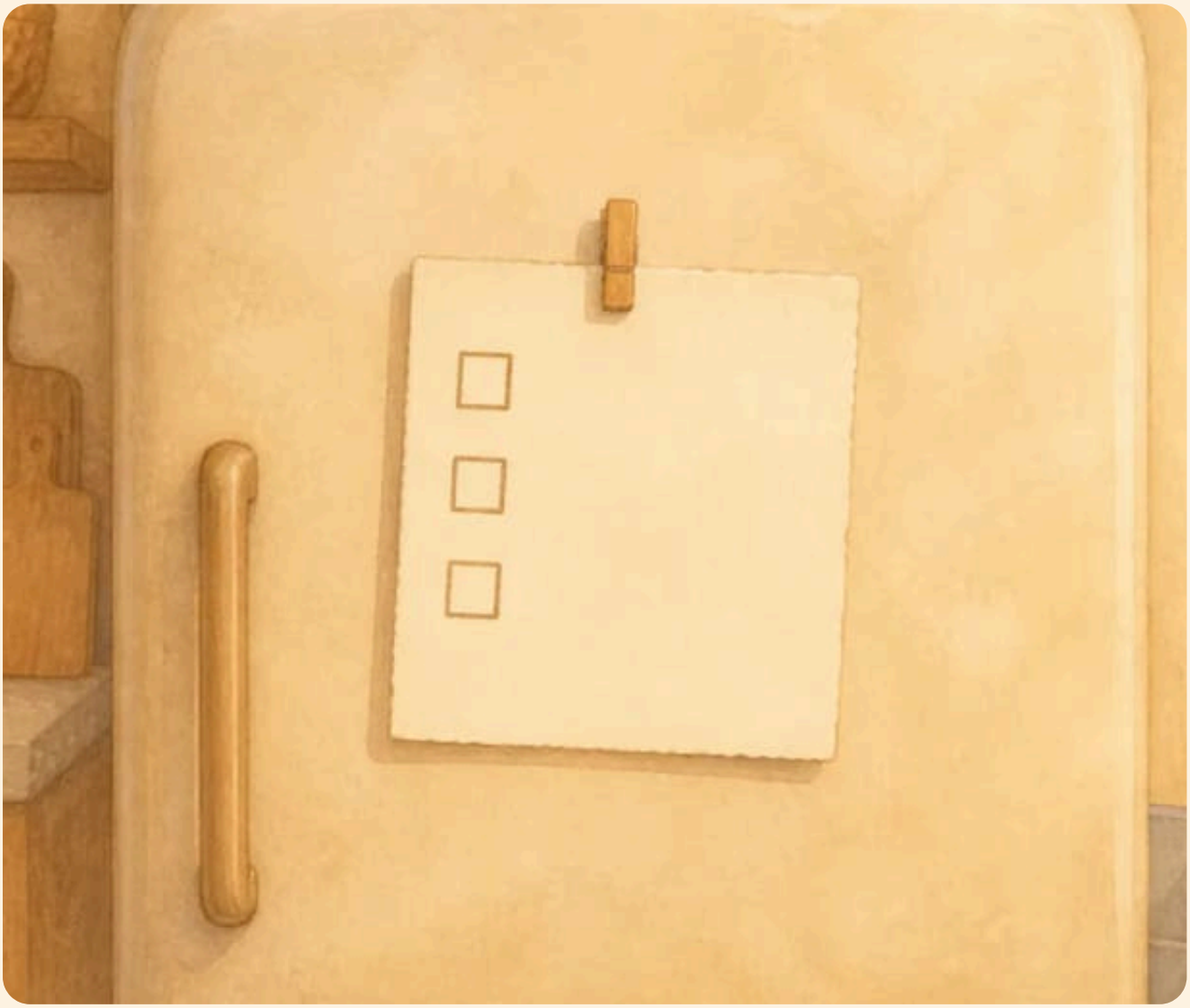
WHAT TO REMEMBER

Try this week

- [ ] Delay the solution for one breath
- [ ] Do something that does not need fixing
- [ ] Try: “That surprised you. Let's sit first, then find a way.”

EXTRAS FOR YOUR STYLE

- [ ] Pick one routine and keep it all the way to the weekend.
- [ ] Give your child one genuine choice today — one where you'd accept either answer.
- [ ] Before you fix it, say one feeling word first.
- [ ] Stop at the first try if they say that's enough.



FOR YOU FIRST

5 ways to come back to yourself

Chosen from your style: what you spend yourself on is what needs releasing. Not one of these is for your child.

There's an order most of us have backwards: everyone else gets looked after first, and you get whatever is left. But what's left at nine at night isn't you — it's the part of you that never got to rest.

The next five pages don't ask you to be a better parent. Nothing here is counted, nothing is reported, and not one of them is for your child. They're all for you, and they aren't a reward you have to earn first.

What's on them isn't random either. Every parenting style spends itself differently: some parents run out from anticipating, some from deciding, some from holding everybody's feelings. So whatever drains you most is also what most needs releasing.



WHAT DRAINS YOU MOST

F — HOW YOU ORGANIZE THE DAY

Deciding without a rail. Every hour asks for a fresh decision.

C — WHO SETS THE DIRECTION

Steering. You're the one who always has to know the next move.

D — WHEN THE FEELINGS GET BIG

Doing. Loving through action means you rarely get to sit down.

E — COMFORT ZONE OR STRETCH ZONE

Being the energy. Every bit of the fun sets off from you first.

FOR YOU FIRST

Pause before fix-it mode switches on. You may feel something without immediately turning it into a task.

HOW TO USE THESE

Take just one. If only one of these gets used this week, that worked. The rest stay here; they aren't going anywhere.

No time this week? You are still enough.



TIME 5 MIN

One drink while it's still hot

Almost every parent drinks their coffee cold. Not from lack of time, but because there is always one more thing that comes first.

Sit down. Finish the whole thing at its actual temperature, doing nothing else at the same time.



TIME 10 MIN

Decide once, for the week

You are not becoming a Planner. You are refunding yourself twenty small decisions.

Choose this week's dinners, or outfits, or bath nights, in one sitting.



TIME 2 MIN

Say "I don't know yet" out loud

You are used to producing an answer on the spot. Go one round without one, and notice that nothing collapses.

Once today, answer a question with "I don't know yet" — and leave it there.



TIME 2 MIN

Leave one thing undone

Not laziness — practice. If one thing can wait a night and the morning still arrives, your edges get a little more room.

Pick one thing tonight and deliberately leave it: the dishes, the toy basket, the reply.



TIME 10 MIN

Sit still in one spot

You are usually everyone's source of energy. Sitting outside without going anywhere refills something a new activity can't.

Outside, one place, no walking anywhere. Find five things you can see without moving.

5 activities with your child (0–5)

One for each age range, so you can take the one that fits your child right now. Everything is already in your house.



THEN, FOR YOUR CHILD

One emotion word before the action helps your child connect body, feeling, and solution.



0–12 MONTHS · 10 MIN

The texture tour

Naming what a baby is touching builds language long before they can talk.

1. Pick five safe textures: a curtain, a cool window, a wooden spoon, a leaf, a towel.
2. Let their hand land first, then name it.
3. Wait for their sound or look before moving on.

You'll need: Your own house.
Safety first: Skip anything hot, sharp, electrical, or small enough to fit through a toilet-paper tube.
Grounded in: Serve and return (Harvard)



1–2 YEARS · 10 MIN

Walk the tape line

One line becomes a balance beam, a road, or nothing at all. Whatever they turn it into is the activity.

1. Run a straight or curved line of tape along the floor.
2. Walk it once yourself, then stop directing.
3. Follow whatever rules they invent, even if they change every minute.

You'll need: Masking or washi tape.
Safety first: Clear the run of hard furniture corners. Bare feet or grippy socks.
Grounded in: Montessori — freedom of movement



2–3 YEARS · 10 MIN

Pour from a small jug

The classic Montessori presentation: show once, then hand over control completely.

1. Half-fill a small jug and set two cups on a tray.
2. Pour once, slowly, without narrating.
3. Put the cloth where they can reach it and say nothing about spills.

You'll need: A small unbreakable jug and two unbreakable cups, a tray, a cloth.

Safety first: Room-temperature water only. Use light, unbreakable vessels and keep an adult within arm's reach.

Grounded in: Montessori — practical life



3–4 YEARS · 15 MIN

You're the customer

For parents who show love by doing: here the doing is theirs, and you're the one being served.

1. They cook, you order and eat.
2. Accept whatever arrives, including the inedible parts of the game.
3. Slip in one feeling word somewhere: "you look proud of that one".

You'll need: Pots, spoons, cups — whatever is already in the toy box.

Safety first: Nothing from the real stove.

Grounded in: Filial therapy — special play time



4–5 YEARS · 15 MIN

The cushion course

They design it, you attempt it. Being the rule-maker is practice they rarely get.

1. They design the course and set the rules.
2. You go first, and follow their rules exactly.
3. Let them change the rules mid-course, because they will.

You'll need: Cushions, tape, chairs, a blanket.

Safety first: Use only stable, non-folding chairs. Nothing to climb higher than their own hip, with an adult staying close.

Grounded in: Montessori — freedom of movement



No play today? You are still enough.

Keep it, print it, or forget it

This booklet has no targets and counts nothing. Take the one thing that helps and leave the rest.



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